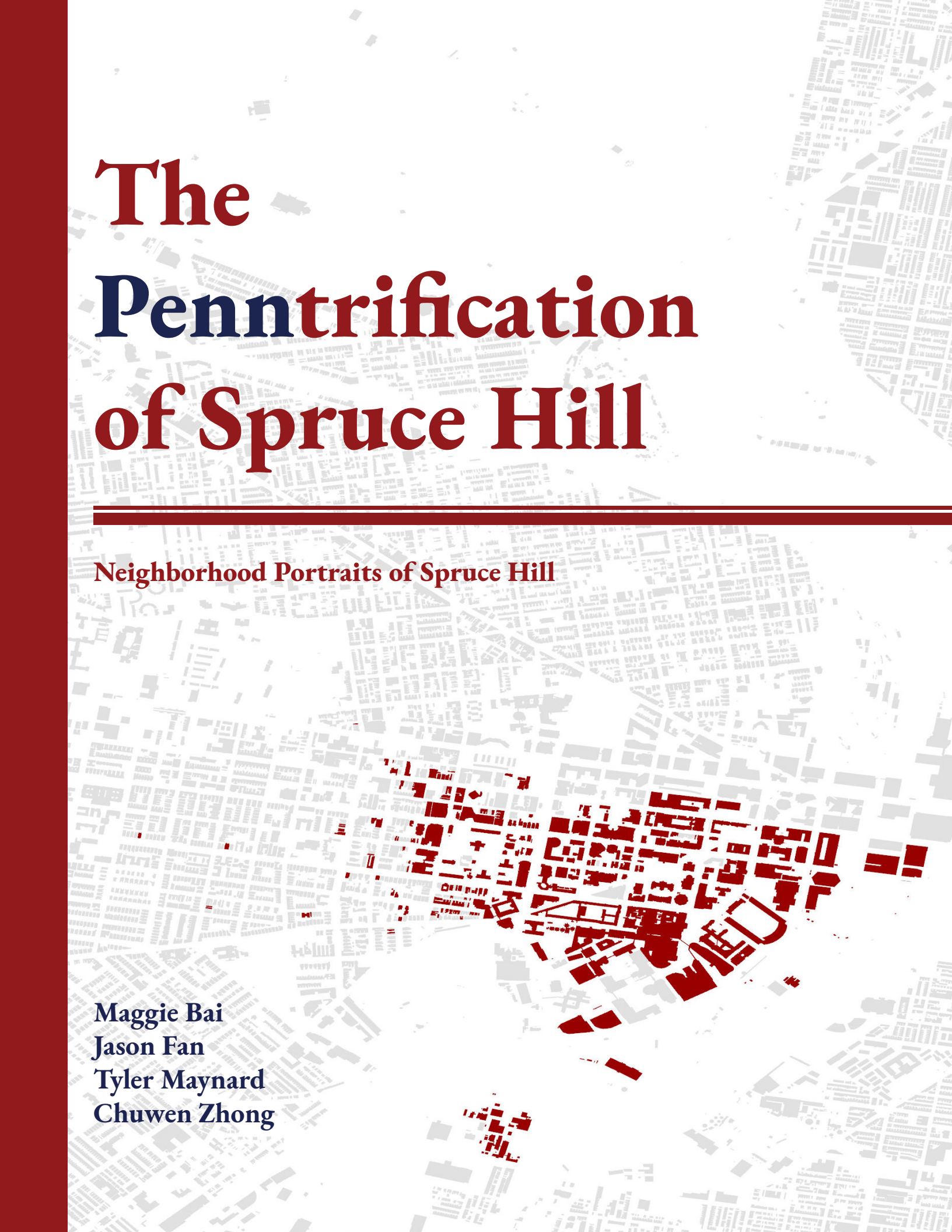


The background of the cover is a light gray aerial map of a city grid. A prominent red overlay is positioned diagonally across the lower half of the image, highlighting a specific neighborhood area. The title text is overlaid on the upper portion of the map.

The Penntrification of Spruce Hill

Neighborhood Portraits of Spruce Hill

Maggie Bai
Jason Fan
Tyler Maynard
Chuwen Zhong

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Reference

Executive Summary

Spruce Hill's history and future are intrinsically linked to the ebbs and flows from the University of Pennsylvania. From its start as a streetcar suburb, to now being a mecca for college and graduate school students living off-campus, Penn has been instrumental in the transformation of Spruce Hill's neighborhood characteristic. Processes ranging from campus expansions, redevelopment of "blighted" regions, and the "urban revival" have all contributed the region's Penntrification. More than the process of gentrification, Penntrification highlights the pronounced influence of Penn in the neighborhood, with a single institution being deterministic of the region's economy and demographics. While policies from Penn are no longer as overt as before, it remains an influential factor in the tempestuous future of Spruce Hill.

The influence is most evident in Spruce Hill's shifting demographics and housing dynamics. The neighborhood has a significant concentration of people aged 20 to 34, particularly in census tracts closest to Penn. Accompanying this trend is a highly educated population, with most residents with bachelor's degrees. However, Spruce Hill struggles to retain long-term residents, as the majority of occupied housing units are rented, and more than 50% of units are over 80 years old. This trend linked to the student-dominated population, with tenures typically lasting only 5 to 12 years.

While Spruce Hill has a higher employment rate than Philadelphia County, its household income remains low. With many students only working part time during their studies, if at all, the neighborhood also has an outsized percentage of residents below the poverty line which is not reflective of the wealth of its residents. Furthermore, the vast number of students leads to the neighborhood having a high number of new residents who only remain in the neighborhood for the duration of their degree. Despite the pervasiveness of Penntrification, Spruce Hill is a rapidly changing neighborhood with a plethora of challenges and opportunities.

Key Stats

Population

Total 14181

60%

between 20-34

0.79%

Male/sex ratio

Employment

62%

Employment Rate

Enrollment

54 %

College or Grad school

House

Total 6886

76%

Renter Occu-
pied

90%

Share Occupied
by renters

Income

63.9%

High poverty
rate

18%

Meadian
household
income below
10k

Commute

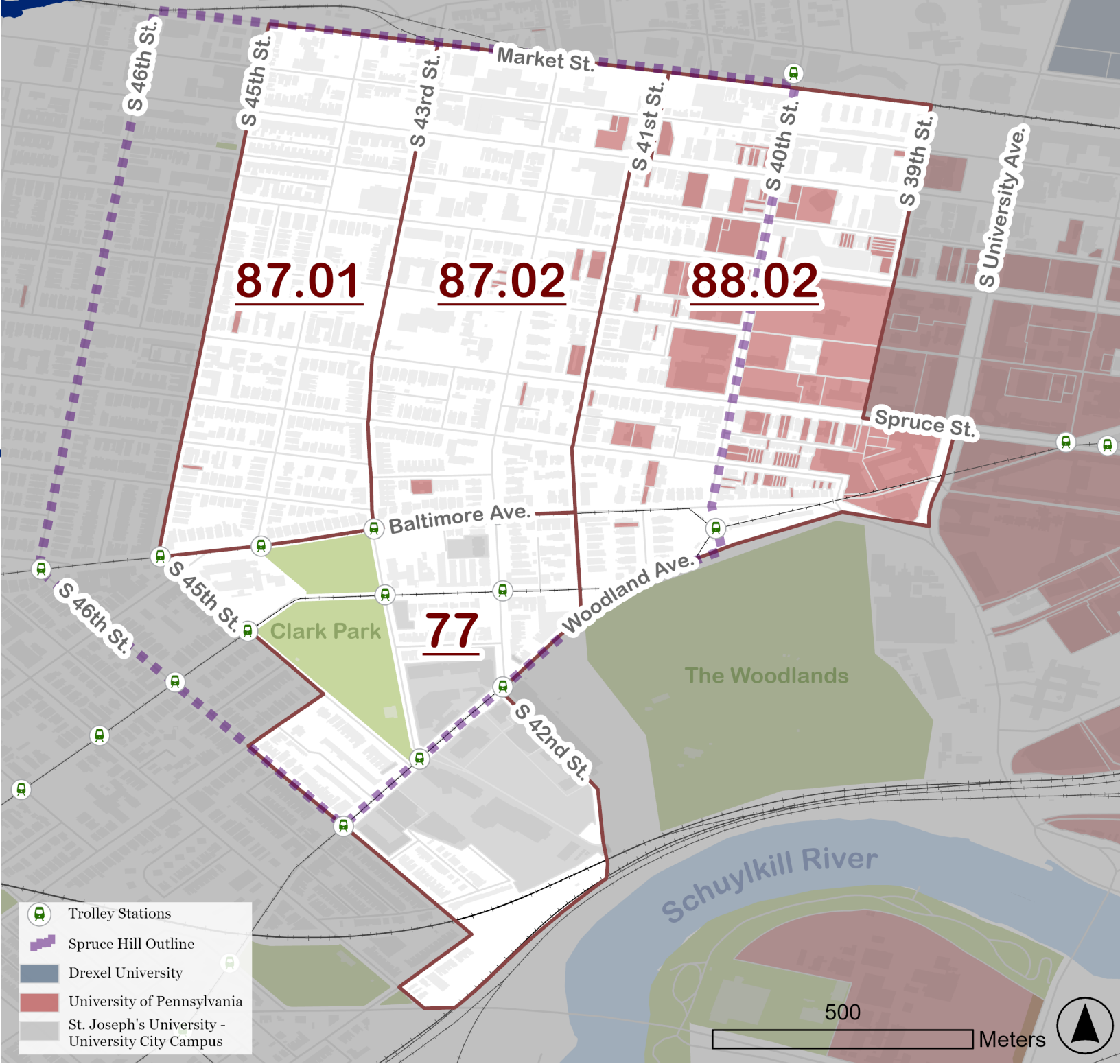
55%

Commute by
walking or transit

Spruce Hill

Spruce Hill

Spruce Hill is a neighborhood in West Philadelphia, bounded by 38th to 46th Street and Market Street to Woodland Avenue. Most of the neighborhood is within the census tracts of 77, 87.01, 87.02, and 88.02, situated inside the University City district.



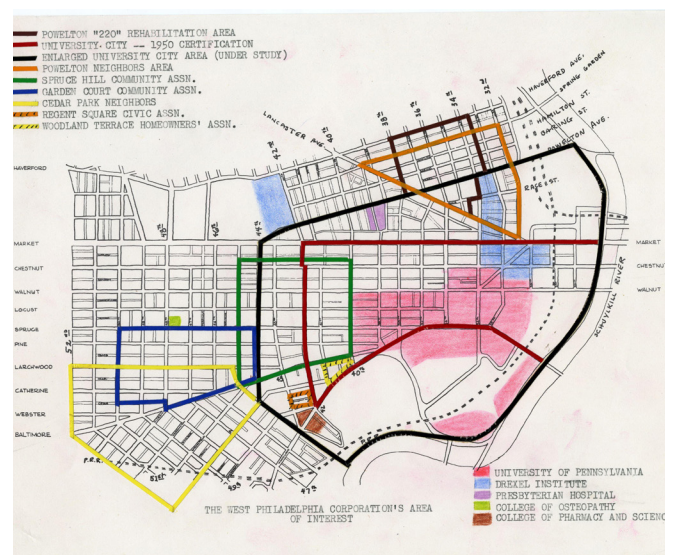
History

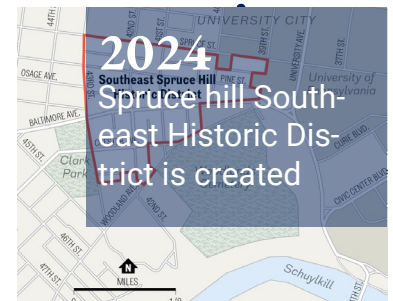
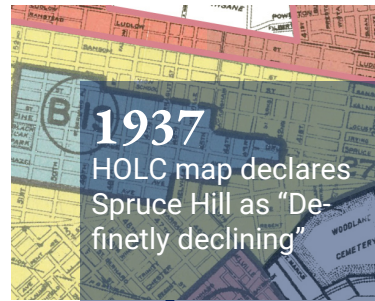
Nestled between the University of Pennsylvania (Penn) and Cedar Park, Spruce Hill is a quaint neighborhood home to one of the largest collections of Victorian-style buildings in the country (Bond, 2024). Following the division of William Hamilton's estate in 1808, Spruce Hill flourished into a neighborhood filled with large Victorian styled estates for the wealthy. With the advent of the streetcar in the mid-1800s commuting became a viable option for many, attracting a diverse community of middle and working-class commuters into the neighborhood. In 1872, Penn followed suit, moving from its Center City campus into West Philadelphia to escape the burgeoning center of Philadelphia it called "a vile neighborhood growing viler everyday" (Massai, 2006). This kick-started the process of expansion, as over the next century, there were only 18 years in which the university did not acquire new property.



Penn's 1913 "master plan" envisioned the university as an enclave "within but separate from West Philadelphia," further separating the institution from the lower income community which it surrounded. In 1948, the Philadelphia City Planning Commission (PCPC) designated an eighty-block area of West Philadelphia as "the University Redevelopment Area", beginning Penn's expansion West of 40th street into the working-class communities of Spruce Hill. The West Philadelphia Corporation (WPC) was formed in 1959—comprising of Penn, Drexel University, University of the Sciences in Philadelphia, and Presbyterian Hospital—taking advantage of urban renewal initiatives to redevelop "blighted urban neighborhoods" around their campuses to create a "University City" which expanded West to 52nd Street.

In 1996, under Penn President Judith Rodin's West Philadelphia Initiatives, "urban revival" programs were developed in the domains of neighborhood safety, housing stabilization/ reclamation, retail developments, and public education investments. Programs such as UCD Ambassadors led to Spruce Hill having an increased concentration of "safety ambassadors" on bicycles patrolling the neighborhood. The Penn Home Ownership Program saw dramatic expansion at this time, leading to over 1,200 Penn families purchasing property in West Philadelphia, much of which in Spruce Hill. Furthermore, the 40th street corridor and Walnut Street were transformed into high-end retail space without acknowledging the traditional businesses and homes that were displaced. In 2024, the "Spruce Hill Southeast Historic District" was created, citing its significance in the economic and cultural development of Philadelphia as a streetcar suburb. This classification means more than 500 homes in the neighborhood are now protected from demolition or modifications to the building's external appearance.





Penntrification

"Penntrification", a portmanteau word between Penn and gentrification, underlines the extractive relationship between the institution and the communities in West Philadelphia. Gentrification is often denoted as the process of neighborhood change as affluent households move into generally poorer neighborhoods, leading to the displacement of its less affluent residents. In the case of Spruce Hill, Penntrification describes the same process of displacement with emphasis placed on Penn's role as an institution. Unlike the traditional process of gentrification, Penn-trification is the total transformation of a region to be reliant and serving towards the institution. This process can be seen through traditional metrics of gentrification—increase of property value, educated residents, and family income—along with the shifts in industry and demographics being directly serving of Penn.

Demographics

Population and Age Structure

Existing Condition

Spruce Hill is experiencing a significant population decline. In 2022, the total population was 14,181, marking a 25.71% decrease compared to ten years ago. Despite this, Spruce Hill has a notably young population, over 80% of its residents are younger than 35, and 60% fall within the 20-34 age range. The age structure of the entire neighborhood is very young. In contrast, Philadelphia experienced a 1.2% population increase between 2012 and 2022, with only 25% of its total population aged 20-34 (Figure 1).

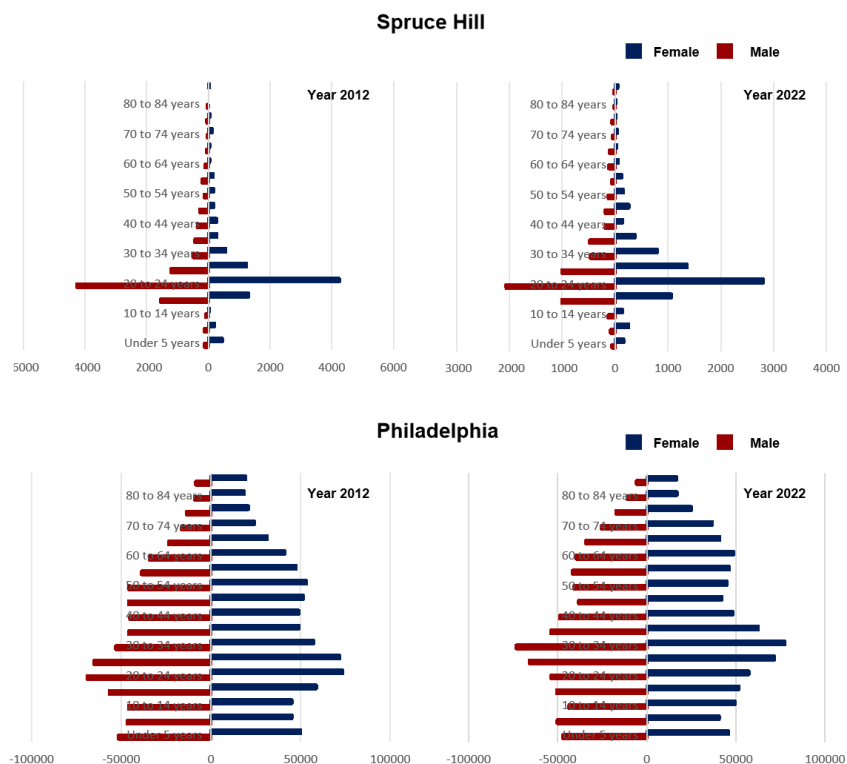


Figure 1: Spruce Hill and Philadelphia age distribution in 2012 and 2022.

Race

Spruce Hill maintains its racial diversity, with the three main racial groups being White, African American, and Asian (Figure 2). The White population remains the largest group, comprising 57% of the total population in 2022, while about a quarter of the population identifies as Asian. In contrast, the Black or African American population represents a smaller share in Spruce Hill (16%) compared to Philadelphia, where it accounts for 43%. Only about 9% of Spruce Hill residents identified as Hispanic or Latino in 2022.

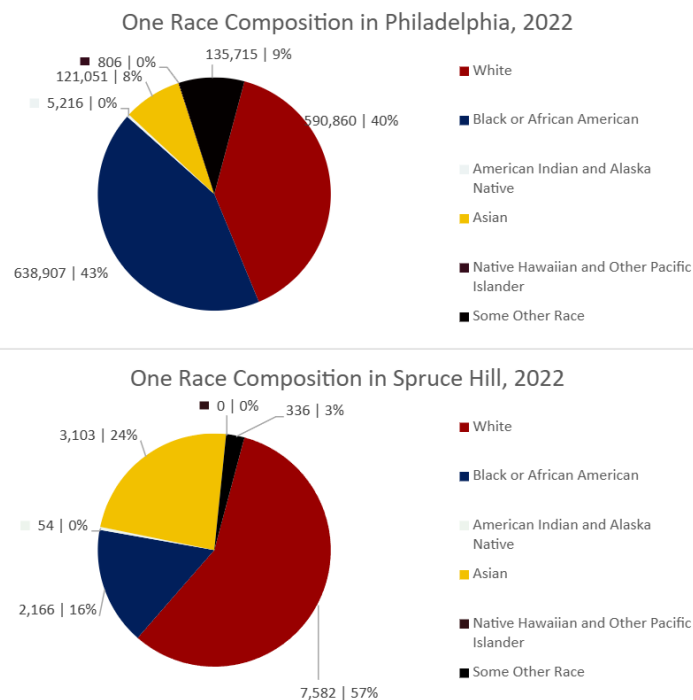


Figure 2: Spruce Hill and Philadelphia racial distribution.

Education

Attainment and Enrollment

Educational attainment and enrollment in Spruce Hill are prominent than in Philadelphia. Despite Spruce Hill’s declining population, the share of residents with college degrees has increased. In 2012, nearly 60% of residents 25 years and older held at least a bachelor’s degree, with half of that share having a graduate degree. Jumping to 2022, nearly half of Spruce Hill residents 25 and older hold a graduate degree, and almost 80% hold at least a bachelor’s degree. This speaks to the Penn’s impact on the population composition in terms of education.

Comparing educational attainment in Philadelphia, the trend is inverted. Between 2012 and 2022, the percentage of residents 25 years and older with at least a bachelor’s degree grew from about 22% to 28%. However, the compositional change in graduate students decreased to only 5%. Educational attainment increased in both areas, though the compositional change in Spruce Hill is noticeably larger.

School enrollment in Spruce Hill is dominated by those attending college or graduate school. In 2022, students enrolled in college or graduate programs represented 90% of individuals aged three and older who were in school. In contrast, college students in the county account for just over 30%, with elementary and middle school students making up the largest share. Figure 4 illustrates how the presence of college students in Spruce Hill has evolved over time compared to Philadelphia.

The number of school-enrolled residents has significantly declined, dropping from 13,221 in 2012 to 8,659 in 2022. This decrease is mainly due to a reduction in college and graduate students, which fell from 12,544 to 7,767. While there has been an increase of 2,000 residents with bachelor’s or graduate degrees, rising rents and the impacts of the COVID-19 pandemic have likely contributed to the decline in college students. This trend underscores the essential role of college students in the neighborhood.

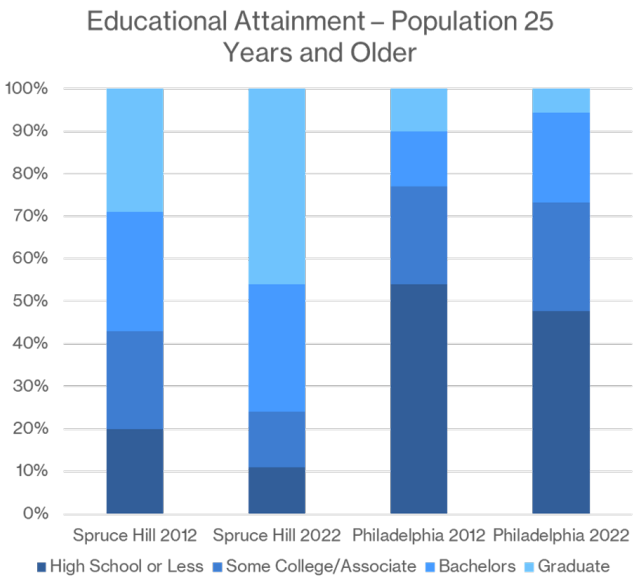


Figure 3: Share of education attainment based on Census ACS 5-Year Estimates.

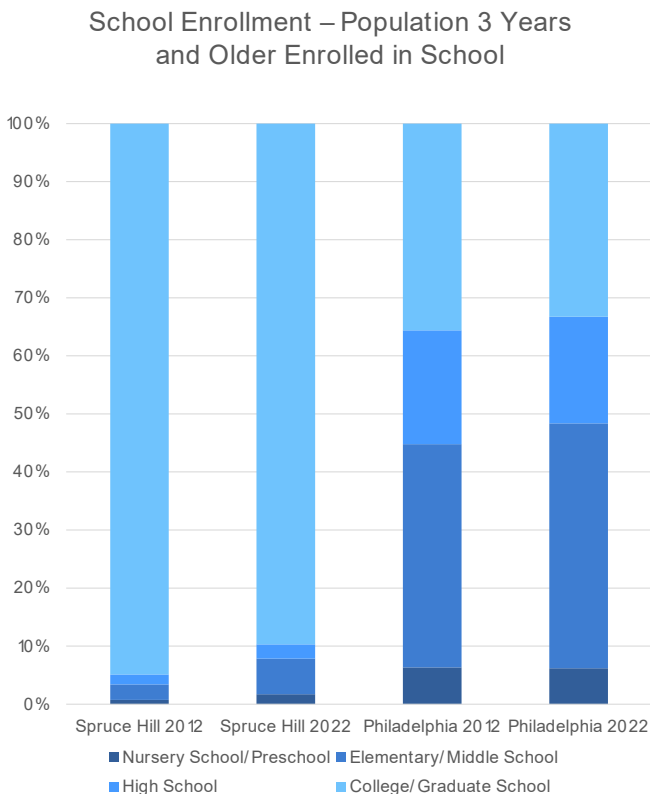


Figure 4: Share of school enrollment based on Census ACS 5-Year Estimates.

Education

Institutions and Partnerships

Spruce Hill hosts an array of educational institutions, including two universities, two public schools, four private schools, and an archdiocese. Many of these establishments have some connection to the University of Pennsylvania for reasons such as course opportunities and financial dependency. Below a select number of institutions are explored with varying relationships to Penn.

Paul Robeson High School for Human Services

Paul Robeson High School for Human Services is located in the northern part of Spruce Hill at the corner of S 42nd St. and Ludlow St. It offers S.T.E.M. elective courses by Drexel University and the University of Pennsylvania. The school has received state recognition, winning Best High Schools in Pennsylvania in 2019 by U.S. News & World Report.



Figure 5: Paul Robeson High School for Human Services

Penn Alexander School

Penn Alexander School, located on the 4200 block of Spruce St., opened in September 2001 and teaches grades K - 8. Penn contributes \$1,330 per student to maintain low student-teacher ratios. The University also maintains the school's green space, provides student teachers from the Graduate School of Education, and supports Penn Alexander School student growth and development through intervention by the School of Social Policy and Practice.



Figure 6: Penn Alexander School

Penn Dental Medicine

The Robert Schattner Center is located on the periphery of Spruce Hill at the intersection of S 40th St. and Locust St. The 16,500 sq. ft. Center was constructed in 2002 and serves as the public entrance to Penn's School of Dental Medicine. The School's footprint was further expanded in 2018 by the addition of Schattner Pavilion, which boasts meeting and gathering space, a new patient waiting area, and a courtyard.



Figure 7: Penn Dental Medicine

The institutions in Spruce Hill demonstrate the significant impact of the University of Pennsylvania on the neighborhood. Through financial investments, academic partnerships, and infrastructure development, Penn shapes educational opportunities and community resources. However, its expansion, particularly with the Penn Dental Medicine facilities, reflects a trend of university-driven initiatives that transform Spruce Hill. This relationship highlights both the enhancement of educational opportunities

Housing

Ownership vs. Tenancy and Housing Stock

Rental properties play a significant role in shaping the housing landscape in Spruce Hill. As of 2022, the neighborhood had nearly 6,900 dwelling units, with 90% of the 5,900 occupied units being rented. In comparison, 2012 data showed 6,100 housing units, with 88% of the 5,400 occupied units rented. This rental composition dramatically exceeds Philadelphia’s 48% share of rented households. Notably, the absolute number of rented occupied units increased while the number of owner-occupied households decreased, even though the overall number of housing units rose.

The average household size in Spruce Hill has decreased. In 2012, owner-occupied units averaged four people, while renter-occupied units averaged threepeople. By 2022, both averages had dropped by one person. In contrast, Philadelphia maintained averages of three for owner-occupied and two for renter-occupied units.

Furthermore, a growing number of residents are choosing to live alone. In 2012, householders made up only 35% of the household population, while non-relatives accounted for 45%. By 2022, the share of householders rose to 58%, while non-relatives’ share decreased to 18%. The number of unmarried partners nearly tripled by 2022, although they still represented a small fraction (6%) of the household population. Single-person households accounted for 61% of all households in Spruce Hill in 2022,

reflecting a 13% increase since 2012. Conversely, the share of single-person households in Philadelphia declined by two percentage points.

As a result of a shrinking household size and proliferation of single-person households, the number of bedrooms has also decreased. Of all housing units in the neighborhood, roughly 60% are either studios or one-bedroom dwelling units in 2022. Ten years prior, this share was at 50%. Not only has the composition changed, the absolute number of studios and one-bedroom units has also increased from 3,072 in 2012 to 4,244 in 2022. This differs from Philadelphia at large. Though the number of units jumped from 139,523 to 153,309 the share remained at 21%. This demonstrates the unique property of Spruce Hill as a neighborhood of renters when compared to the county.

Housing structures in Spruce Hill gnerally have multiple units. Only about 1,100 housing structures in Spruce Hill contain a single unit in 2022, dropping from 1,300 in 2012. Comparing to Philadelphia, the location quotient for share of housing structures with at least two housing units was 2.46 in 2022, indicating a strong demand for multiunit housing in Spruce Hill.

Area	Spruce Hill – 2012	Spruce Hill – 2022	Philadelphia – 2012	Philadelphia – 2022
Total Housing Units	6,148	6,886	669,244	730,630
Owner-Occupied	642	599	314,076	344,149
Renter-Occupied	4,775	5,254	266,433	314,980
Vacant	731	1,033	88,735	71,501

Figure 8: Change in housing unit composition in Spruce Hill and Philadelphia between 2012 and 2022.

Housing

Tenure of housing occupancy in Spruce Hill is notably shorter than in Philadelphia. In 2022, 88% of Spruce Hill householders moved in between 2010 and 2022, compared to only 59% of Philadelphia householders during the same period. The location quotient of 1.49 suggests a trend of more frequent moving in Spruce Hill, possibly due to the high number of college-aged residents relocating to and from the area. The location quotient 2012 was 1.54, indicating that this has been a long-standing characteristic of the neighborhood.

Residents of Spruce Hill allocate a significant portion of their household income to housing costs, particularly renters. Overall, 58% of residents paid at least 30% of their income on housing in 2022, an increase from 56% in 2012. In Philadelphia, 44% spent at least 30% of their income on housing and only 38% did in 2022. Renters are particularly affected, with about 62% spending at least 30% and 53% spending 35% or more of their income on housing.

The neighborhood and Philadelphia have greater concentrations of older housing units. Approximately 57% of housing units in Spruce Hill were built in 1939 or earlier, and 87 percent were built before the 21st century. In Philadelphia, 41% of housing units were constructed before 1940 and 92% before 2000.

Spruce Hill suffers from high vacancy rates, especially for rental properties. In 2022, the number of vacant housing units grew by 41 percent since 2012. This means that vacant housing accounts for 15% of all housing in Spruce Hill, a compositional increase of three percent from 2012. The homeowner vacancy rate in Spruce Hill was 0.0. in both 2012 and 2022, suggesting that this issue lies within the realm of rentals.

Housing in Spruce Hill primarily consists of multi-unit, single-occupancy rental units, which serve as a viable housing solution for college-aged residents.

Rent Burden in Spruce Hill - 2022

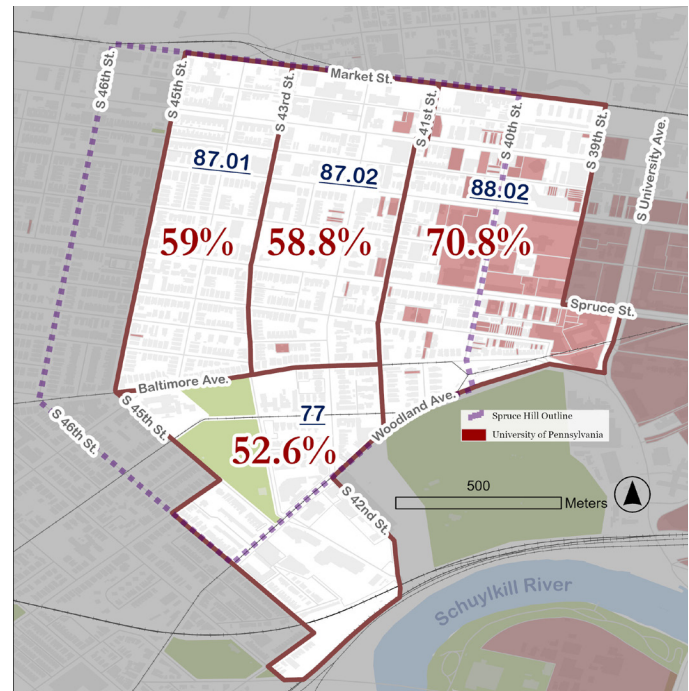


Figure 9: Residents closer to Penn's campus experience higher rent burden.

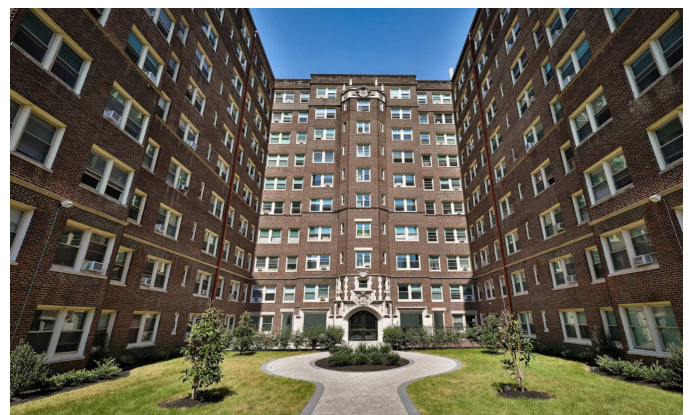


Figure 10: Fairfax Apartments is a 10-story high rise complex in Spruce Hill, an example of multifamily housing found in the neighborhood.

Socio-Economics

Neighborhood of Non-family Households

As this census tract extends as far East as 39th street, it includes six Penn college houses and 16 Greek organization houses. This means over 40% of the residents in census tract 88.02 are undergraduate students who are assumed to not be as involved in the work force. This assumption is further enforced with census tracts closest to Penn [88.02 and 87.02] having most non-family households with 80 % and 86% respectively. Non-family households only account for 49% of all households in Philadelphia, while it accounts for 80% of households in Spruce Hill (see Figure 11).

It is interesting to note that non-family households decreased for census tract 88.02 from 87% in 2012 to only 80% in 2022, while increasing for 87.02 from 84% in 2012 to 86% in 2022. While it appears contradictory to the idea of more students living closer to Penn, this discrepancy can be explained when noting that Penn started requiring sophomores to live in college housing starting in 2021 (Tan, 2018).

Employment Rate

As a neighbourhood with an outsized school enrollment, it finds itself with a 62% employment rate, two percentage points higher than Philadelphia County. Census tract 88.02, being the tract closest to Penn, sees the lowest employment rate of 51%. Looking at the distribution of employment rate by census tract, it becomes clear that employment rate greatly increases the further away from the University it is census tract 87.01 having an employment rate of 82%. Fittingly, the closer the census tract is to Penn, the higher percentage of commuters are walkers with walking being the method of commuting for over 50% of workers in census tract 88.02.

Income and Poverty

Despite having a higher employment rate compared to Philadelphia County, 18% of Spruce Hill residents have a household income less than \$10,000 compared to Philadelphia County with 9.7%. The higher number of low household income and high employment rates shows that many residents of Spruce Hill are likely to work part-time or in their early career, leading them to likely be students.

Like employment rates, the household income exhibits a similar trend with census tracts closer to Penn having a higher percentage of households earning less than \$10,000. In addition, the poverty rate for the census tract closest to Penn has a poverty rate of 64% (see Figure 12). As students are included in the calculation for poverty rate, the high number for census tract 88.02 further indicates the prevalence of students in the neighborhood.

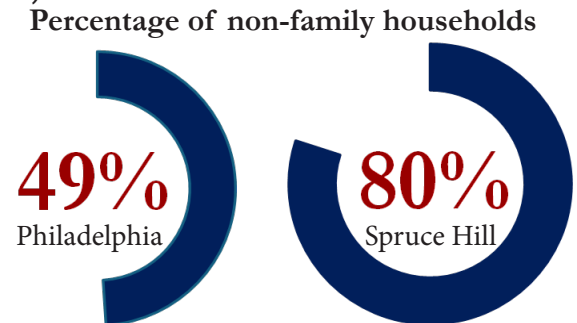


Figure 11: Percentage of non-family households in Philadelphia and Spruce Hill

Percentage of People Living Below the Poverty Line

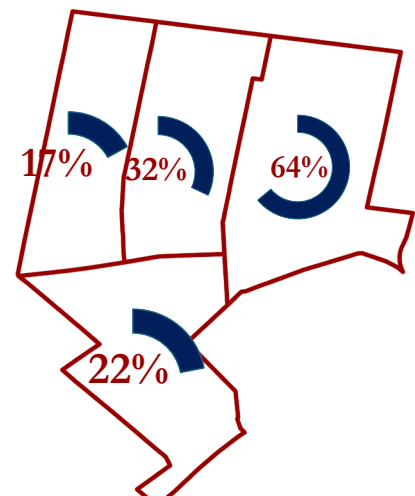


Figure 12: Percentage of people living below the poverty line

Employment and Industry

Change in Industry Structure

From 2012 to 2022, overall employment in Spruce Hill grew by approximately 13.5%, driven by explosive growth in the transportation industry, which expanded from just 1 employee to 1361. This substantial change was mainly due to Amazon Fresh Pickup University City receiving an operating permit around 2018, bringing a number of warehousing jobs to Spruce Hill (Figure 13). Meanwhile, the education, healthcare, and accommodation and food services sectors experienced a slight decline, while retail, manufacturing, information, and real estate rental sectors saw significant declines of approximately 50% (Figure 14).

In comparison, Philadelphia County experienced a smaller increase in employment but

maintained a more stable industrial structure compared to Spruce Hill. By comparing the employment proportions across industries in 2022, Spruce Hill shows a notably higher share in transportation and warehousing as well as educational services compared to Philadelphia. This is because, in addition to the support for the warehousing industry from the local Amazon Fresh Pickup University City, the City School also steadily providing education-related jobs for this neighborhood. However, the Professional, scientific and technical services and Health care and social assistance in Philadelphia account for a significantly larger proportion compared to those in Spruce Hill.

Industry Structure in Spruce Hill

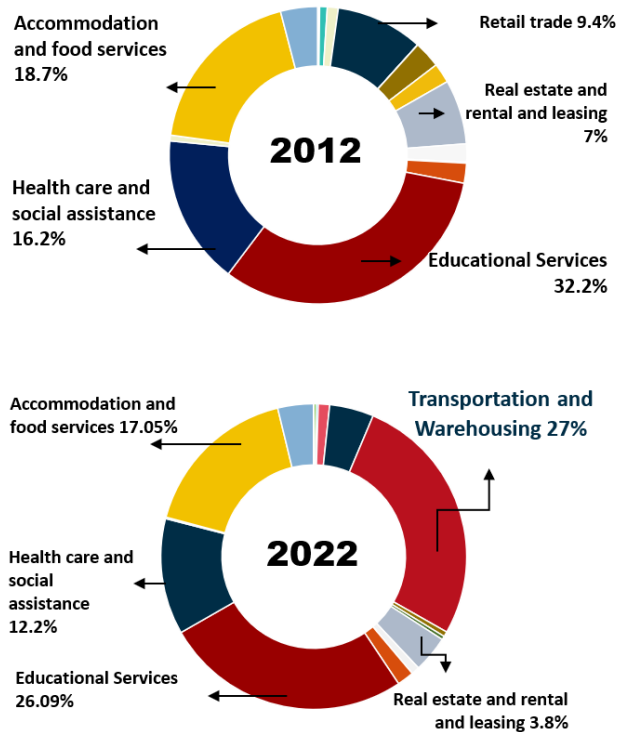


Figure 13: Industries in Spruce Hill.

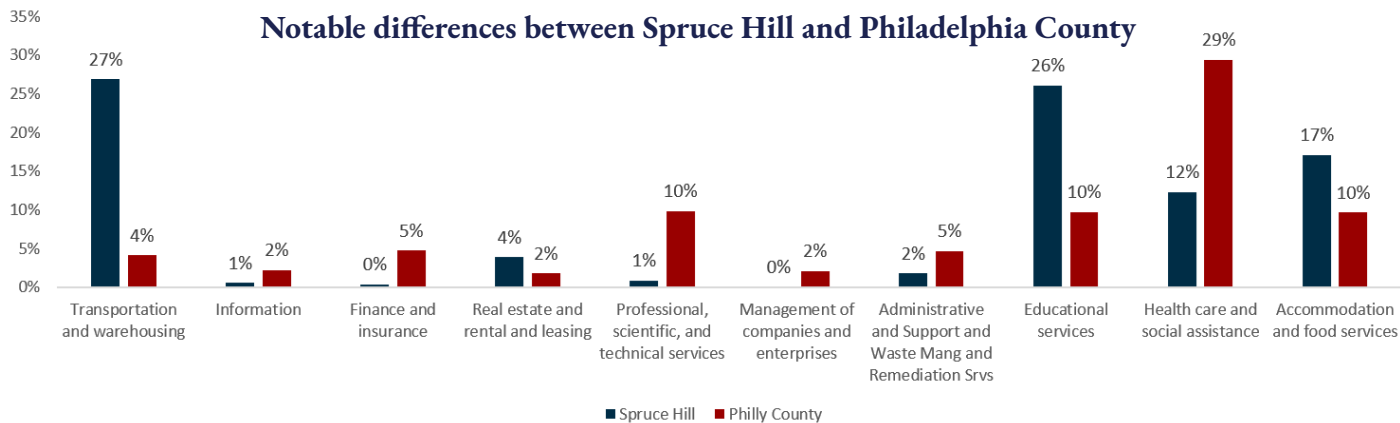


Figure 14: Significant changes in industries in Spruce Hill.

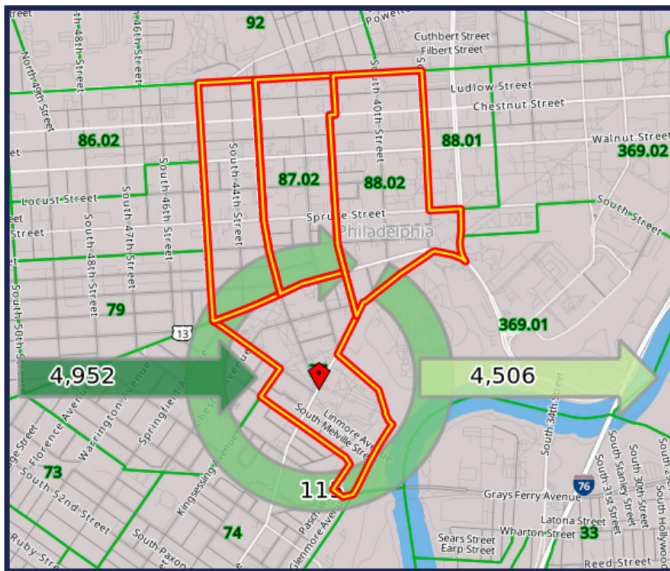


Figure 15: Employment flow chart in Spruce Hill.

However, the majority of people employed locally do not reside in Spruce Hill. From the flow chart, in 2022, around 5000 people employed in Spruce Hill but live outside, and about 4500 residents commuted out for work. Building on the earlier information that Spruce Hill exhibits a trend of younger population with relatively low average income but high educational attainment, it can still be inferred that the residents of this neighborhood are likely students or education professions, as they are not employed in local industries and commute outside for work. While local industries, especially transportation and warehousing and educational services, rely on external commuters.

Basic Industries

The changes in basic industries also reflect the shifts in the industrial structure of the two regions. Figure x shows shifts in industry structure between Spruce Hill and Philadelphia from 2012 to 2022. In Spruce Hill, the basic industries transitioned significantly, with transportation and warehousing emerging as the leading industry by 2022. However, traditional industries like retail trade, information, and educational services experienced a decline. For Philadelphia, the focus shifted toward professional, scientific, and technical services, alongside management of

companies and health care, showing an increasing emphasis on professional and care-oriented industries. Overall, Spruce Hill's transformation centers on warehousing and transportation growth, while Philadelphia's economy increasingly specializes in professional services and health care.

	Spruce Hill 2012	Spruce Hill 2022	Philadelphia 2012	Philadelphia 2022
Basic Industry	1. Retail trade 2. Information 3. Real estate and rental and leasing 4. Educational services 5. Accommodation and food services	1. Transportation and warehousing 2. Real estate and rental and leasing 3. Educational services 4. Accommodation and food services	1. Transportation and warehousing 2. Finance and insurance 3. Professional, scientific, and technical services 4. Management of companies and enterprises 5. Educational services 6. Health care and social assistance 7. Arts, entertainment, and recreation	1. Professional, scientific, and technical services 2. Management of companies and enterprises 3. Educational services 4. Health care and social assistance 5. Arts, entertainment, and recreation
Emerging Industry	1. Transportation and warehousing			
Declining	1. Retail trade 2. Information 3. Real estate and rental and leasing 4. Educational services 5. Accommodation and food services		1. Transportation and warehousing	
Specializing			1. Professional, scientific, and technical services 2. Health care and social assistance 3. Educational services	

Figure 16: Basic industries in Spruce Hill.

Projected Statistics

Population

Based on a step-down average share model, Spruce Hill is expected to have a population of 18,067 in 2030. To project 2030 Spruce Hill population, the step-down average share model was employed. Ideally, this analysis would have used the cohort-survival method; however, data limitations at the neighborhood level rendered this impracticable. The simple trend and step-down growth share models yielded a very low population due to the decrease between 2012 and 2021, which is believed to not accurately represent growth trends. The step-down average share model strikes a balance that generates

Methodology - Education and Housing

Given the complexities and differences in education and housing shifts from 2012 to 2021, the simple trend model would not sufficiently capture these nuances. For example, owner-occupied housing trended in opposite directions (occupancy in Spruce Hill decreased while it increased in Philadelphia). Thus, we believed the step-down most recent growth share would serve as a more accurate model. Philadelphia was used as the reference area since it would share more similar traits to Spruce Hill than other larger areas such as Pennsylvania or the U.S.

Education

Based on a step-down most recent growth share model, projections for educational attainment in Spruce Hill reiterate the studentification of the neighborhood. The total population 25 years and older will experience a minor growth (5,478 to 5,824) with a more robust 66% share of graduate school alumni. Furthermore, the number of residents with at most a high school diploma will continue to shrink, further revealing the impact of the neighborhood's proximity to Penn can be seen clearly.

Housing

Over the last decade, housing in Spruce Hill has shifted to become more focused on rentals. Additionally, a deemphasis has been placed on single-unit housing options. Looking ahead to 2030, these trends are expected to continue. Renter-occupied housing will increase from 4,899 to 5,011 in 2030 with a relatively stagnant number of owner-occupied housing. In Philadelphia, however, owner-occupied housing will increase by 6% (361,181) and renter-occupied housing will increase by 12% (344,916). Figure 18 shows changes in terms of housing stock.

Spruce Hill Projected Education Attainment
2021 (Inner) to 2030 (Outer)

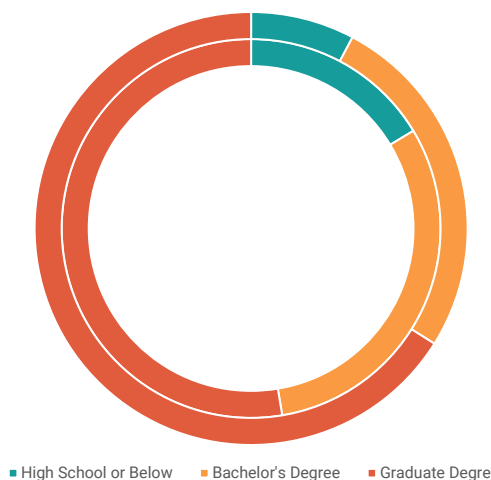


Figure 17: Projected education attainment in Spruce Hill.

Spruce Hill and Philadelphia Projected
Housing Stock 2021 to 2030

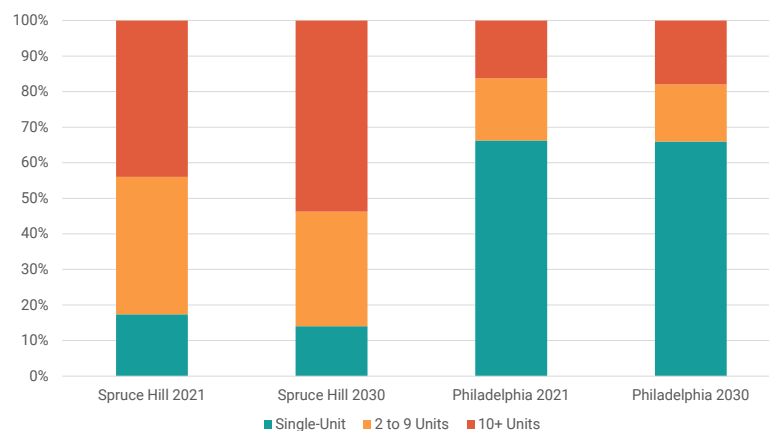


Figure 18: Projected housing by number of units in structure.

Employment Projection

To predict the employment and industry changes in Spruce Hill by 2030, we chose the shift-share and step-down growth share methods. We choose to use these two methods because the unexpected surge in transportation and warehousing in Spruce Hill caused the shift-share model to be inaccurate. However, the shift-share model can still be used to examine the dynamic changes in other industries. Therefore, the total employment in Spruce Hill for 2030 is predicted using the step-down growth share model. The reference area for both models is Philadelphia County.

The predicted results show that if we assume the employment growth rate in Spruce Hill from 2021 to 2030 remains the same as the previous 9 years at 32.2%, the total employment in the neighborhood will exhibit a steady growth trend and could reach 16,042 people.

Using the shift-share model, we established a scenario for Spruce Hill and Philadelphia County where employment growth remains stable. In this scenario, construction and transportation and warehousing are the two main industries driving local growth. These two industries benefit from the economic growth of Philadelphia

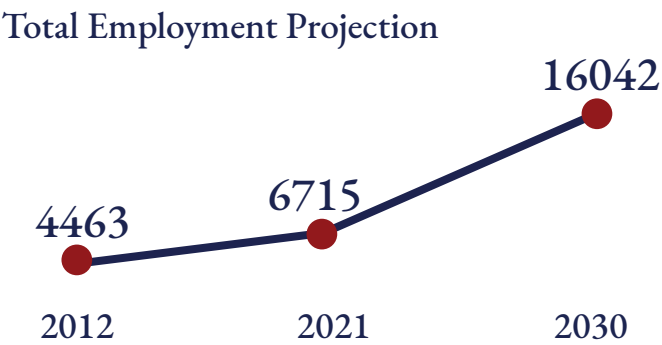


Figure 19: Employment Projection in Spruce Hill in 2030

and also show strong local competitiveness. However, the surge in transportation and warehousing cannot be considered a positive growth signal, as the rise of this industry has contributed to the stagnation and decline of other industries, leading to a more simplified local industrial structure. Therefore, it is recommended that while stabilizing the development of transportation and warehousing, efforts should be made to promote the development of other industries, so as to diversify the local industrial structure.

Challenges and Opportunities

Challenges of Penntrification	
High Population Mobility	Dominance of Rental Housing
Spruce Hill's proximity to the Upenn and other educational institutions drives a disproportionately high influx of 18-24-year-olds, significantly exceeding the city average. This student-driven migration, combined with the short-term nature of student housing and young professionals' brief employment stints, results in frequent population turnover and a lack of long-term residents, undermining community stability.	Spruce Hill's housing market is dominated by rental units, with 89.77% of all occupied housing being renter-occupied. The growth of large multi-unit rentals, increasing from 28.03% in 2012 to 38.83% in 2022, reflects a market tailored to student housing demand. This heavy reliance on student demand also creates market instability, particularly if university-driven housing needs fluctuate.
Imbalanced Age Structure	Income Inequality
Spruce Hill is experiencing population loss. Although the 20-24 age group holds a large share of the population, the declining birth rate and the loss of the middle-aged population suggest that the area may face potential issues of demographic imbalance in the future.	Despite overall income growth, Spruce Hill faces significant income disparities linked to studentification. In 2022, residents lived below the poverty line was higher than Philadelphia's average. Student-driven income gaps exacerbate this issue, as students, lacking stable earnings, lower overall income statistics while driving demand for increasingly expensive rentals.
Opportunities against Penntrification	
The Penn Alexander School is currently ranked the fifth best middle school in Pennsylvania and receives a yearly \$1,330 per student subsidy provided by Penn. While the school has a student population of 595, there are 715 school aged children within Penn Alexander's catchment area. This means that students living within Spruce Hill are not able to take advantage of the Penn Alexander school and must travel outside of the neighborhood for school. With Spruce Hill being largely dominated by college and graduate school students, expanding enrollment for the Penn Alexander school can make the neighborhood a more attractive place for families to reside.	
Leveraging Penn's Influence to Establish a New High School	
To extend the length of residency for local families and reduce frequent student migration, Penn's influence can be leveraged to establish a high school, creating an integrated middle-to-high school education system in conjunction with Penn Alexander School. This initiative would encourage families with middle school children to remain in the area longer, attract more long-term residents, and promote homeownership over renting. By doing so, the community's stability would be strengthened, addressing the high turnover rate caused by student migration.	

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End Notes

umerous old and lovely Victorian houses. Being designated a historic district helps protect the appearance and the integrity of the structures in the area. This can attract visitors who appreciate historical sites and archit